

Atelier

Serialized audiobooks — read
and listen chapter by chapter

AI STUDIO

READER CATALOG

CHAPTER AUDIO

NEXT.JS

~90%

LOWER PROD. COST VS STUDIO

\$0.99–1.49

PER-CHAPTER UNLOCK

1 stack

DRAFT → AUDIO → SELL

100%

CLIENT-OWNED CATALOG

Level 12 solution documentation · commissioned for an independent studio operator

The Client's Challenge

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Independent creators who publish **serialized audio fiction** cannot move from draft manuscript to **monetized, listenable chapters** in one workflow. Writing, narration, catalog hosting, and per-chapter sales live in **separate tools**—not built for serial unlock models.

5+ apps

TYPICAL DIY TOOLCHAIN

\$200+/hr

HUMAN STUDIO NARRATION

3 steps

READER EXPECTS: PREVIEW · UNLOCK · LISTEN

PAIN POINTS

- ▶ Production is **slow & expensive** across fragmented tools
- ▶ Readers expect **preview** → **unlock** → **continue** in one flow
- ▶ **No owned stack** built for a private studio operator
- ▶ Aggregator platforms take **margin + IP risk**

WHAT THE CLIENT NEEDS

- ▶ **Exclusive** private production workspace ("/studio")
- ▶ **Owned catalog** with chapter-by-chapter sales
- ▶ **AI + TTS + payments** without juggling five apps
- ▶ **Pocket-FM economics** on infrastructure they control

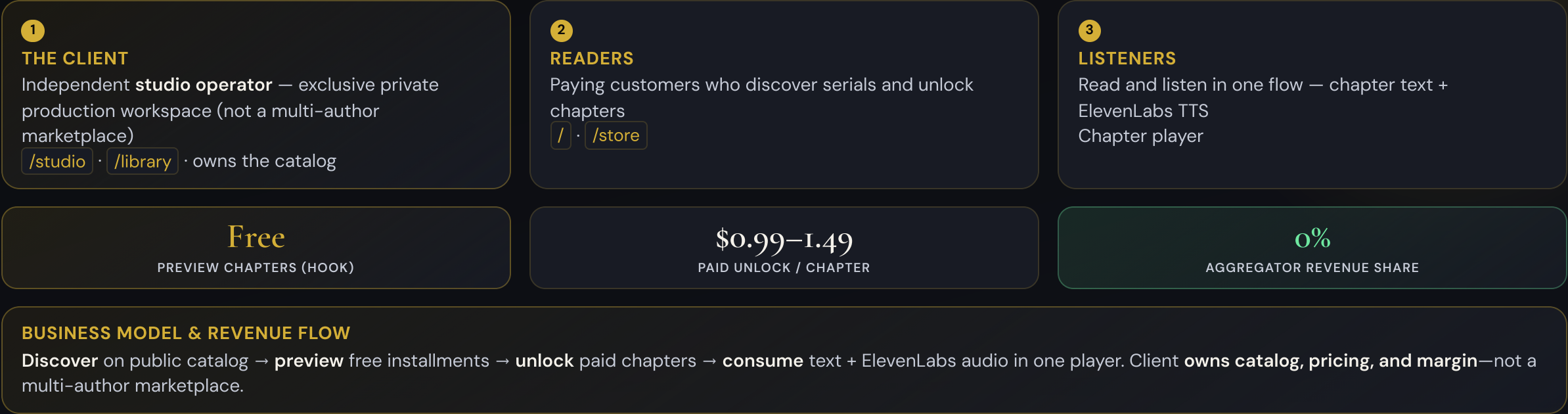
Competitive Landscape

ALTERNATIVE	WHY IT FALLS SHORT FOR OUR CLIENT
Pocket FM & serial apps	Strong listener UX — client does not own production or catalog
Wattpad · Vella · Radish	Serial fiction — no integrated AI + TTS + owned workflow
DIY toolchain	Scrivener + ElevenLabs + payments — slow, expensive , poor unlock UX
AI writers alone	Fast drafting — no catalog, audio, or chapter monetization

Market gap: Strong serial-fiction demand exists—but no platform gives an indie operator **owned production + owned catalog + AI + TTS + chapter unlocks** in one stack.

Atelier — private studio → narrate → publish → unlock → listen, in one app the client controls.

Client & End Users



What Atelier Is & How It Works

WHAT THE SOLUTION IS

Atelier is a full-stack web application unifying a **private AI studio**, **text-to-speech narration**, **serial catalog publishing**, and **chapter-by-chapter monetization** in one Next.js codebase.

CREATOR PATH

- 1. **Draft** — OpenAI chat + agents (`/studio`)
- 2. **Narrate** — Server-side ElevenLabs TTS
- 3. **Publish** — Story/chapter management (`/library`)

READER PATH

- 1. **Discover** — Public catalog (`/`)
- 2. **Preview** — Free chapters
- 3. **Unlock** — Paid access (`/store`)
- 4. **Consume** — Chapter player (text + audio)

~\$2.50

TTS / ~10-MIN CHAPTER

~\$0.04

LLM DRAFT PASS

~3 unlocks

BREAK-EVEN @ \$0.99

~90%

LOWER COST VS STUDIO

CREATIVE GUARDRAILS (SERIAL MEMORY)

- **Per-thread agent isolation** — no cross-book bleed
- **Story-controls schema** — genre, mood, tension, sophistication
- **Prior-chapter injection** — plot continuity across 50+ chapters
- **Quality retries** + `[Speaker]` tag preservation on refine

DATA SOVEREIGNTY

- **PostgreSQL** owns manuscripts, unlock ledgers, comments
- OpenAI & ElevenLabs are **swappable server adapters**
- Provider change ≠ IP loss — assets stay in client DB

What We Shipped

 Reader catalog — Shadows in the Diner

1 · READER CATALOG

 Creator studio — chat and manuscript

2 · CREATOR STUDIO

 Chapter player — Listen to chapter

3 · CHAPTER AUDIO

Catalog



Studio



Listen + unlock

AI studio

- ▶ OpenAI chat + isolated agents
- ▶ Live manuscript + refine loops
- ▶ Admin-only `/studio` workspace

Owned catalog

- ▶ Publish & price per chapter
- ▶ Free preview + paid unlock rules
- ▶ Public `/` + `/store` storefront

Chapter audio

- ▶ ElevenLabs TTS in-player
- ▶ Lock-state UX from walkthroughs
- ▶ Text + audio single surface

Why Atelier Wins

ATELIER ADVANTAGE	PRODUCT BENEFIT
Private studio — not a marketplace	Client controls IP, voice, and release cadence
Write + narrate + sell in one app	Faster chapters, lower production cost
Serial unlock UX built-in	Preview → pay → continue—like Pocket FM, but owned
API-first web MVP	Same backend for future iOS/Android apps
Owned PostgreSQL IP layer	Manuscripts, unlock ledgers, reader data—no vendor lock-in
Swappable AI providers	OpenAI & ElevenLabs are server adapters; core assets stay in client DB

Bottom line: Pocket-FM listener UX + indie-studio economics + zero aggregator lock-in — on infrastructure the client owns.

How We Built It

STACK	RATIONALE
Next.js App Router	UI + API in one codebase — fast delivery for the client
PostgreSQL + Drizzle	System of record for IP, unlock ledgers, comments — data portability
Serial memory	Prior chapters + story-controls schema injected into LLM context per generation
OpenAI + ElevenLabs	Swappable server-side adapters — keys never in the browser
Auth.js	Sessions, account deletion, admin studio access
API-first	Web MVP today · iOS/Android on same API later
Client studio / Readers → Next.js API → PostgreSQL → OpenAI · ElevenLabs	
6 routes CORE API SURFACES Server-only AI KEYS NEVER IN BROWSER API-first MOBILE = SAME REST LAYER	

Objectives, Evidence & Feedback

OBJECTIVE		RESULT	EVIDENCE
End-to-end creator → reader pipeline	MET MVP		<code>/</code> · <code>/studio</code> · <code>/library</code> · player
LLM authoring + TTS narration	MET MVP		OpenAI + ElevenLabs server routes
Structured feedback + smoke tests	PARTIAL		Walkthroughs + <code>pnpm test:smoke</code>
Documented unit economics	MET		<code>docs/CLIENT_PRICING_AND_TCO.md</code>

FEEDBACK	SHIPPED FIX
Locked chapters unclear	Lock reason + value copy
Session expiry during checkout	Re-auth prompt + clear errors
Publish state confusing	Published vs Draft badges
No regression safety	Smoke suite <code>pnpm test:smoke</code>

Validation combined **structured walkthroughs**, **client feedback loops**, and **automated smoke tests** on auth, catalog, studio, and checkout paths.

Phased Rollout & Risk Controls

LIVE PHASE 1 — MVP DELIVERED

- Web client · owned catalog · full studio pipeline
- Stub checkout · TTS tier caps for **cost control**
- Smoke tests on auth, catalog, studio, checkout APIs
- Documented TCO + privacy inventory for stakeholders

NEXT PHASE 2–3 — NO DB REDESIGN

- **Stripe** — verified per-chapter unlock revenue
- **CI** — broader API regression before production launch
- **Mobile** — React Native / Flutter on **same REST endpoints**
- Architecture decoupled **day one** — not retrofit

SECURITY & LEGAL

- Provider API keys stored **server-side only** (OpenAI, ElevenLabs)
- Privacy/data inventory: `docs/APP_PRIVACY_DATA_INVENTORY.md`
- Account deletion via Auth.js · content policy is operator-defined
- Version history: `docs/CHANGELOG.md`

Post-MVP Scaling Strategy

PHASE		DELIVERABLE — SAME API & POSTGRESQL SCHEMA
PHASE 1	Now	Web MVP · studio pipeline · stub checkout · unit economics documented · smoke tests live
PHASE 2	Q-next	Stripe live revenue · expanded CI · production hardening · unlock ledger verified
PHASE 3	Scale	React Native / Flutter · same REST API · zero schema migration · reader apps on owned backend

STRATEGIC POSITION

Serialized audio fiction is growing; indie operators want **Pocket-FM economics** without **aggregator lock-in** — TCO, privacy inventory, and solution docs in [docs/](#)

Citations & Further Investigation

SOURCES CITED

- ▶ **Next.js App Router** — nextjs.org/docs
- ▶ **PostgreSQL + Drizzle ORM** — orm.drizzle.team
- ▶ **OpenAI API** — platform.openai.com/docs
- ▶ **ElevenLabs** — elevenlabs.io/docs
- ▶ **Auth.js** — authjs.dev

FURTHER INVESTIGATION

- ▶ [SOLUTION_DOCUMENTATION.md](#) — Level 12 brief + rubric mapping
- ▶ [CCC_DELIVERABLE_REPORT.md](#) — plan, risks, test evidence
- ▶ [CLIENT_PRICING_AND_TCO.md](#) — per-chapter economics
- ▶ [Q_AND_A_BRIEF.md](#) — post-presentation Q&A prep
- ▶ [CHANGELOG.md](#) — version history

Summary

Owned IP

CATALOG + UNLOCK LEDGERS IN POSTGRESQL

Phased scale

STRIPE → CI → MOBILE ON SAME API

SUCCESS CHECK

Client-owned ecosystem with **documented unit economics**, **creative guardrails** for long-form serials, **data sovereignty**, and a **defined post-MVP scaling path**.

- UNIT ECONOMICS
- OWNED CATALOG
- NO LOCK-IN
- PHASED SCALE

Questions?